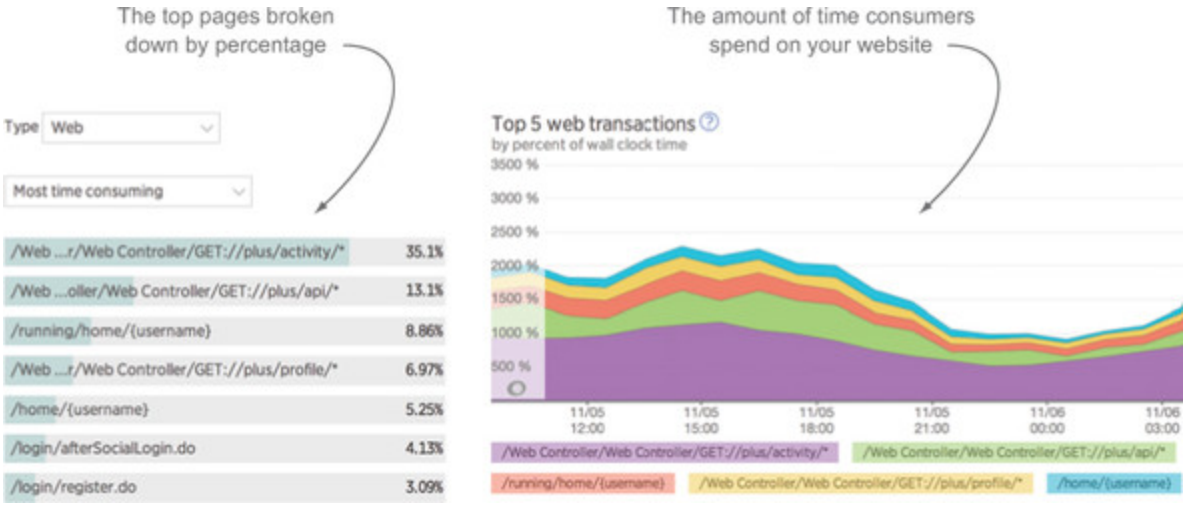



These metrics are interesting because they help inform you about the experience your consumers are having with your applications. It's important to set service-level agreements (SLAs) for your applications to help you define what you think is a good experience. When you do this, don't look at how your application performs now; think of what your consumers expect. Are they okay with a web page that loads in four seconds or should the SLA be under one second? Do they expect to get results from entering data of some kind immediately, or do they just expect to dump some data in and see results later?

Watching how your performance trends toward your SLAs becomes interesting as you compare it to the data we've already looked at from project tracking, source control, and CI. Are you improving team performance, at the expense of application performance, or is application performance a first-class citizen in your development cycle? When development teams are completely focused on new features and don't pay attention to how their product is performing in the wild, it's easy to lose sight of application performance.

**Reacting to application health**

Keeping your application healthy is an important factor in consumer satisfaction. Ideally you want to have great response times and an app that can scale up to whatever your potential consumer base is. A good APM system will tell you when performance is getting bad and will also usually